

FEAR OF 13TH CHORDS!

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #129

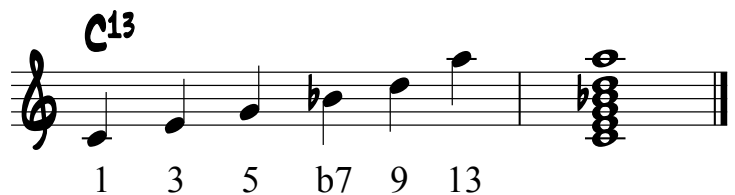
Life was easy back when we didn't know anything about chords. Ignorance was bliss! Eventually, we learned the dominant 7 chord, and before too terribly long, it became second nature. Then, however, we were faced with all of the seemingly endless "extensions" on those dominant chords. #9's and b9's, #11's and 13's and everything else. Oh my.

There is ONE key concept to remember. All those various, perhaps scary chords are simply DOMINANT CHORDS. The many different extensions are just like condiments on the hamburger. They are additions. They are little flavors we are adding on. Just remember, at the end of the day, we are simply working with a dominant chord. Our job? We just have to learn a little bit about each of the flavors in question, so that we know how to use them.

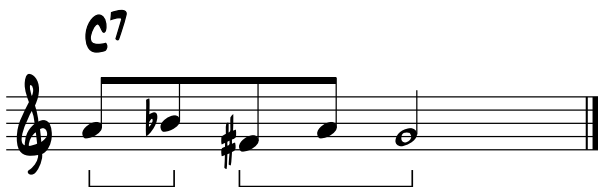
#1 - Dominant 7 Chord



#2 - Dominant 13 Chord



#3 - Approaching the b7



The 6th/13th (the note A) can be used as an approach to the b7 (itches 1 and 2), or in an enclosure, resolving to the 5th (itches 3, 4, 5).

#4 - Brazil



The 6th/13th is a great melodic note, which often connects to the 5th in some way, as it does here.